

ETHEREAL POETRY TAROT GUIDEBOOK

BY

CONSTELLATION & Catalyst

PREFACE

Originally named Rootless Ethereal Poetry, this deck is steeped in the essence of epic storytelling, from its visual language to conceptual depth. Warm parchment tones and soft, textured strokes evoke a dreamlike, distant ambiguity like faded memories. It weaves a quiet journey across dimensions and beyond time, then traces four fragments of forgotten memory, collecting moments buried by the years into a rich, contemplative epic now resting in your hands.

The artwork centers on beings beyond humanity: machines, spirits, and the otherworldly. Why? Because I've always believed that somewhere in the vast cosmos, brilliant and unknowable alien civilizations exist. Human history is but a ßeeting speck in the grand current of space

and time. Ethereal Poetry thus invites you to step outside familiar frameworks. It offers a glimpse through a window to other worlds – civilizations that might grow along paths wholly different from our own. In doing so, it expands how we think about life, civilization, the universe, and existence itself.

Within the creative process and the card imagery lie hidden threads: The Sun, The Hermit, the drifting clouds and watching eyes, or The Fool departing, returning, and evolving through endless iteration... Meta-elements are deliberately placed to foster interaction and reflection, quietly breaking the fourth wall.

Let this deck travel with you across time and space.

~ Sickle

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PRELUDE

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I stand in an open void.

I see clouds drift across the sky faraway.

Everything is washed in pale sepia, like faded photographs, forgotten poems, or memories lost between cracks of time.

"Where... am I?"

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There's something behind me.

I turn and see a towering bookshelf.

I'm in a room now.

It's dark, enclosed on all sides. The clouded

sky is visible through the window facing the shelf, looking so far away.

A beam of light pours in, catching motes of dust in its path. Like fate pointing the way, it lands on a book toppled over.

I reach out and lift it from the dust.

Its cover is faded and worn. Beneath the peeling edges, I can just make out the title: Ethereal Poetry.

Ethereal Poetry...

Who wrote this? What stories does it tell?

I open the fragile cover. The yellowed pages come loose and scatter like leaves.

They flutter through the air, dancing with the breath of life. The words, faint and aged, play a quiet rhythm across the paper.

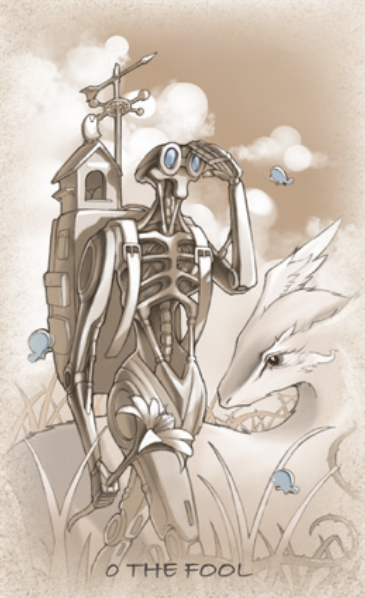
Softly, like the sepia sky.

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ANALYSIS OF THE MAJOR ARCANA



0.THE FOOL

Information:

Element: Air

Astrology: Uranus

Keywords: New beginnings, adventure, freedom, innocence, ignorance

Interpretation:

Amid an open wilderness, the Fool gazes toward the distant unknown, setting off on an uncharted journey. With silver-blue goggles and a searching stance, the Fool scans for direction. The backpacks lung over both shoulders holds not only supplies for the expedition but also the accumulated experience and knowledge of the past. A weathervane sways uncertainly in search of orientation, while the chick perched atop a small cabin also looks ahead in curiosity and anticipation.

Yet, no journey is truly easy. Though the landscape seems gentle and open, hidden among the grasses are thorny dangers, hindering the Fool' s steps. In one hand, the Fool holds a white flower resembling a lily—symbolizing the mechanical being' s innocent and untainted perception of the world at the outset of the voyage. Its fragrance draws butterflies to flutter around in gentle circles.

A rare and loyal companion, the white dog walks beside the Fool. As the Fool presses forward, the dog glances back, as if watching over them—offering both companionship and a silent warning to be mindful of the danger at their feet.

Upright:

A new beginning or fresh start, the onset of an event, a sense of adventure and the courage to take the first step, innocence and childlike wonder, freedom and spontaneity, curiosity, instinct, and authenticity,entering a completely new environment, thinking or acting unconventionally

Reversed:

Blind optimism or arrogance, stubbornness, impulsiveness and reckless behavior due to lack of preparation, unrealistic expectations, poor timing, stagnation or hesitation,taking risks without considering the consequences



1.THE MAGICIAN

Information:

Element: Air, Earth

Astrology: Mercury

Keywords: Creativity, Action, Transformation, Realization, Potential

Interpretation:

The Magician, perhaps better called a Sorcerer, is someone who wields the power of the four elements and channels their creativity to perform miracles. Towering amidst the mist, the Magician stands holding the Wand and the Cup aloft toward the heavens, while the Sword extends downward to connect with the earth, symbolizing the alignment of their creative force between heaven and earth. These foundational four elements are firmly grasped and continuously manipulated, unleashing their potential through constant transformation. A radiant white halo encircles the Magician, mirroring the infinity above their head—a symbol of boundless energy and creativity. At the heart of all wondrous changes lies the creativity within. The Magician, focused intently, opens the door at their chest, releasing their inner creative power. Miracles unfold like a breathtaking magic show, captivating and awe-inspiring.

Upright:

Creativity and innovation, harnessing potential, communication and connection, taking control, intention and decisive action, mastery of skills or techniques, utilizing resources effectively to achieve goals,turning ideas into reality and solving problems with ingenuity

Reversed:

Deception and illusion, loss of control or disconnect, inadequacy and inability, failing to reach potential,empty promises and lack of follow-through, misuse of skills or lack of practical action, resulting in unmet expectations



2.THE HIGH PRIESTESS

Information:

Element: Water

Astrology: Moon

Keywords: Reason, wisdom, intuition, subconscious, silence

Interpretation:

The crescent moon’ s soft elegance and wisdom are inseparably intertwined with the High Priestess. A veil of moonlight-like fabric drapes down, concealing her visage beneath its gentle folds, as she illuminates the realms of wisdom and intuition with a subtle, radiant glow.

An ancient tree lifts the veil slightly, resembling Jerusalem’ s Boaz and Jakin, embodying the abstract concept of duality in tangible form. The letters "B" and "J" are carved into the tree’ s bark, symbolizing their essence.

In her hands, the book of wisdom lies open, and from its pages grows a serene tree radiating white light,while a stream of wisdom flows forth in winding paths. Gentle rains descend, symbolizing intuition flowing downward, blending with the stream. These two waters ripple together, creating waves that are slightly cool yet deeply feminine.

Amidst the mist and over the water, paper boats

drift quietly. Upon them stand seekers of wisdom and spirituality, gently floating as they ponder: *Where did they come from, and where are they destined to go?*

Upright:

Calmness, silence, rationality, wisdom, contemplation, sharp perception, intuition, spiritual power,subconscious, mystery, secrets, meditation, intellect, deep insight, isolation, revelation, spiritual growth,mental connection and inner awareness

Reversed:

Ignorance, shortsightedness, arrogance, selfishness, lack of rational thinking, indifference, aloofness,weak spiritual strength, nervousness, neglecting inner intuition, being misled, secrecy, concealment,excessive isolation, self-doubt, unease



3.EMPRESS

Information:

Elements: Earth, Air

Astrology: Venus

Keywords: Prosperity, Motherhood, Abundance, Harvest, Nurturing, Fertility

Interpretation:

The Empress embodies nature itself, serving as the mother of all living things, bringing fullness and vitality to life. Beneath an open sky where birds soar freely, the noble Empress stands under the heavenly light. A magnificent flower blooms upon her shoulder, its shining pistil symbolizing the strength of femininity and motherhood. She wields a delicate scepter crowned with brilliance, a mark of her regal elegance and authority.

Her body reveals cracks from which ripe pomegranate seeds spill forth, representing her nurturing power and the life she bestows upon the earth. The abundant harvest of golden wheat fields around her signifies material prosperity and vitality, cultivated under her care. The upright, plump grains symbolize her creations, standing as her devoted subjects who gaze up in reverence at their nurturing mother. These flourishing creations, born from her love and grace, now offer tribute to

their benevolent queen, singing hymns of her love and generous blessings.

Upright:

Maternal energy, harvest, creativity, prosperity, nurturing, elegance, wealth, love, beauty,academic or professional success, traditional maternal bonds, passion, strong feminine temperament,harmony, unexpected financial gains

Reversed:

Oppression, scarcity, poverty, vanity, wastefulness, arrogance, indulgence, lack of focus or reason, imbalance, difficulty in self-reconciliation, unfulfilled relationships or marriages, obstacles in creation or childbirth, miscarriages



4.EMPEROR

Information:

Elements: Fire

Astrology: Aries

Keywords: Power, Authority, Control, Stability, Leadership

Interpretation:

Before a range of towering mountains, the Emperor sits regally on his throne, clad in unyielding armor.The vast expanse of his domain stretches across the rugged peaks, a testament to his conquest and absolute rule. His colossal throne reaches into the clouds, symbolizing his elevated stature and the magnitude of his responsibilities. In one hand, he wields the Ankh, a scepter symbolizing eternal life, and in the other, he holds an orb that represents dominion and prosperity. These symbols announce his sovereignty over the material world, his capacity to achieve ambitions, and his unshakable control over his realm.

The Emperor’ s command ensures order among his subjects, who bow before him in reverence. Yet, this is not a position of ease. Cracks mar the foundation of his throne, hinting at the burdens of maintaining authority. His armor remains firmly in place, signifying a readiness for perpetual battle

to secure his rule.The crown atop his head weighs heavily, embodying the immense responsibility he bears. His lowered gaze reflects the somber reality of kingship: "He who wears the crown must bear its weight."

Upright:

Leadership, power, authority, consolidation, stable order, ability to control situations, make decisive judgments, take action, connections to traditional paternal roles, material ambitions, reserved approach to emotions

Reversed:

Immaturity, lack of determination, indecisiveness, loss of authority or misuse of power, feelings of insecurity, inability to control situations, lack of responsibility or initiative



5.THE HIEROPHANT

Information:

Elements: Earth

Astrology: Taurus

Keywords: Religion, Guidance, Truth, Teaching, Tradition

Interpretation:

The Hierophant embodies the power of faith and spiritual guidance, serving as a bridge between the mortal and the divine. As the Elder Tree, the Hierophant represents both ancient wisdom and the everlasting nature of spirit and belief. The triple crown atop the tree trunk symbolizes religious authority,uniting the heavens, earth, and humanity. The sacred scepter of the Hierophant rests against the trunk,signifying divine authority and spiritual harmony.

Branches stretching upward connect to higher realms, while ribbons cascading downward embody the transmission of faith and tradition. These elements unify religion and spirituality, reflecting balance and continuity.

At the base of the tree, a devoted disciple kneels, embodying dedication and adherence to tradition. Listening intently, the disciple absorbs the tree' s wisdom, embracing its teachings and guidance. The blooming roses in the garden represent the

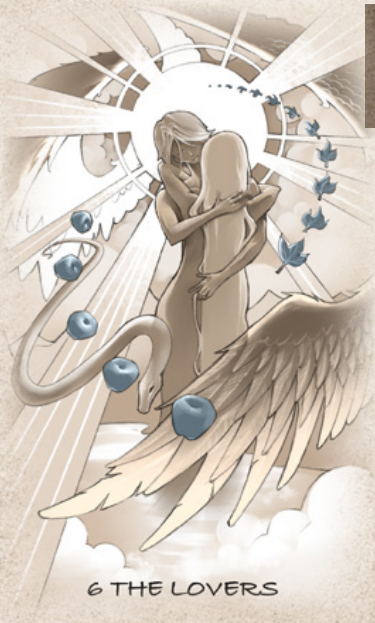
disciple' s fervor for faith. Crossed keys rest at the roots of the tree, waiting to unlock the doors to wisdom and spiritual enlightenment.

Upright:

Wisdom, guidance, truth, teaching, expertise, spiritual assistance, transcending material concerns for spiritual growth, receiving help from a mentor, compassion, steadfast belief, reliable or trust worthy individuals, intervention from elders

Reversed:

Over-reliance, misleading guidance, blind or ineffective assistance, spiritual oppression, prejudice,rigidity, dogmatism, and inflexibility, hypocrisy, insincerity, rebellion, excessive or inappropriate goodwill



6.THE LOVERS

Information:

Elements: Air

Astrology: Gemini

Keywords: Love, Relationships, Communication, Connection, Cooperation, Choices

Interpretation:

By the waters of Eden, two lovers stand face to face, embraced under the radiant blessing of an angel.Their embrace symbolizes the profound connection and open communication that binds them, embodying trust, mutual reliance, and a deep understanding born of sincerity.

Surrounding them are apples, a serpent, and fiery leaves. The forbidden fruit and the serpent of Eden represent human temptation and desire, reminding us that love also involves choices and trials.

Interaction and communication within a relationship often require navigating decisions and primal instincts.The twelve fiery leaves symbolize the zodiac signs, representing the flame of life and desire. This passionate union fuses emotion, spirit, and longing.

Behind them, the wings of Archangel Raphael extend, casting a divine light of protection and

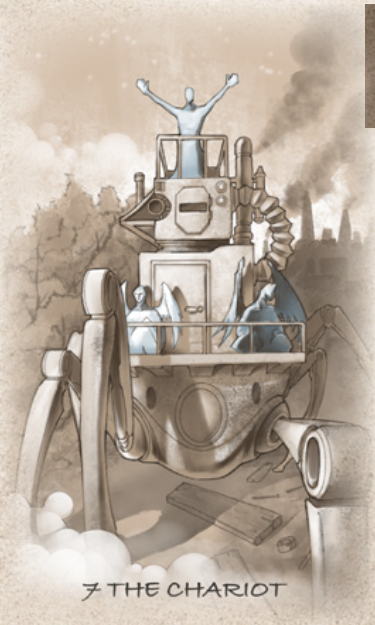
blessings over the lovers. His presence offers support and guidance, affirming the sanctity and harmony of their connection.

Upright:

Innocence, mutual affection, a sweet and blessed relationship, equality and mutual respect in partnerships, facing pivotal decisions and important choices, smooth communication and collaboration,the pursuit of one's true self

Reversed:

Conflict in relationships, separation, third-party interference, betrayal, infidelity, an unblessed union,external temptations, falling prey to subjective errors in judgment, lack of wisdom and discernment,inequality in the relationship, poor decision-making



7.THE CHARIOT

Information:

Elements: Water

Astrology: Cancer

Keywords: Willpower, Discipline, Victory, Spiritual and Mental Growth

Interpretation:

The Chariot symbolizes the power of will and determination, roaring forward as a sign of progress toward success and triumph.

The warrior guiding the chariot spreads his arms wide, steering it not with reins or external control but through sheer force of will. Two creatures, a black sphinx and a white sphinx, drive the chariot forward.They represent opposing choices and perspectives. Behind them lie two contrasting landscapes: a dense forest on one side and a bustling city on the other, symbolizing the diverging paths one may take in life.

Through his willpower and ability to balance and command the opposing forces, the warrior determines the chariot' s path. Charging ahead without hesitation, even as parts may fall away, he embodies the unstoppable pursuit of victory and progress.

Upright:

Victory, triumph, conquest, confidence and determination, taking bold action and moving quickly,unwavering willpower and clear direction, strong willpower, unwavering determination, taking the helm,moving forward with clear and resolute direction, war

Reversed:

Excessive desire for control, loss of control, irrational behavior, deviating from the original direction or course, being stuck in a stalemate, traffic accidents or incidents, unexpected impacts, encountering obstacles or resistance, reckless collisions, potential for conflict or disputes



8.STRENGTH

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Leo

Keywords: Courage, Patience, Inner Strength, Confidence, Composure

Interpretation:

Under the maiden's gentle touch, the mighty lion gradually calms, softly closing its eyes.

The maiden, dressed in a flowing gown, her silver hair swaying in the breeze, exudes warmth and tranquility. Her presence reflects immense inner strength. Despite the overwhelming size and primal power of the lion before her, she remains composed. With calm courage and serene determination, she tempers the lion’ s impulses and instincts, stroking its mane and taming it with her soft yet firm will. This harmonious balance is a testament to the warmth and nurturing power of her inner strength.

The primal lion, once driven by instinct and raw energy, is now serene, its wildness subdued. Closing its eyes peacefully, it allows delicate butterflies to alight upon its face. This imagery symbolizes the triumph of the maiden’ s gentle strength over the lion’ s ferocity, achieving a state

of profound harmony.

Upright:

Confidence in life, gentle on the outside but strong within, courage, overcoming primal instincts, resolute and decisive actions, calm and composed demeanor, patience, vibrant energy, robust health

Reversed:

Weakness and incompetence, loss of confidence and courage, unsuitable for action, inability to restrain primal instincts, inner turmoil requiring resolution of negative emotions and thoughts, powerlessness and inferiority, anger and tendencies toward violence, self-doubt



9.THE HERMIT

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Leo

Keywords: Courage, Patience, Inner Strength, Confidence, Composure

Interpretation:

Amidst the dark, mountainous terrain cloaked in night, the Hermit stands alone, draped in a long robe and holding a luminous lantern. Some say this is the Fool who, after a long journey, has grown into a wiser figure, vastly different from his once naive and impulsive self. The bird that once accompanied the Fool now rests quietly atop the Hermit’ s head, a witness to his growth. Together, they climb arduous peaks, finding stillness and self-reflection in solitude and darkness.

The Hermit's true visage lies hidden beneath his robe, and his staff supports him through the storms of his journey. His eyepiece reflects a glimmer of wisdom, which converges in the light of the lantern he carries. The six-pointed star radiates from within the lantern, its brightness emanating from the harmony of opposing forces—ascending and descending energies. This glow symbolizes the light of truth and the subcon-

scious, guiding the Hermit toward self-discovery and the answers within.

He raises the lantern high, its flame illuminating his path while offering a beacon of inspiration to others in search of wisdom and truth.

Upright:

Seeking truth, seclusion, solitude, introspection, spiritual exploration, academic research, paperwork,extensive data collection and organization, studying obscure knowledge, a spirit of inquiry, meditation,withdrawal from the world, nostalgia

Reversed:

Distancing from the mundane, alienating oneself from others, self-isolation, lack of communication,obsession with trivial details, compulsive tendencies, avoiding problems, unwillingness to face reality,stubbornness, rejecting others' advice and perspectives, stagnation, pretentiousness



10.WHEEL OF FORTUNE

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Jupiter

Keywords: Cycle, Fate, Change, Opportunity, Turning Point, Expansion

Interpretation:

The traveler stands at the center of the Wheel of Fortune, gazing toward the distant sun as divine forces set the wheel in motion. The unpredictable rotation reflects the cycles of fate, pulling life along its course.The spinning disk wavers, revealing fleeting figures—glimpses of countless possibilities within the twists of destiny. Each person is entangled in the turning wheel, advancing or retreating through life's pivotal moments.

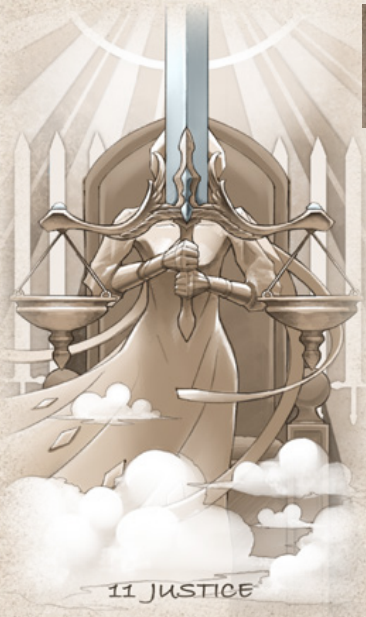
The traveler stands at the wheel's core, navigating their own destiny while surrounded by the symbols of the four elements, which guide their steps. Encircling the outer rim of the wheel, three deities silently shape its direction. Apep' s serpent tail drags the wheel toward ruin, Anubis lifts it, heralding new opportunities, while the wise Sphinx brandishes a sword, urging the traveler to reflect amidst the rise and fall of fate.

Upright:

Destiny, the beginning of a new cycle, long-distance travel (e.g., studying abroad, moving, relocating for work), good fortune, positive transformation, following one' s inner desires, favorable timing, expansion

Reversed:

Unfortunate changes, acceptance of unavoidable fate, misfortune, blocked energy, unsuitable timing for risks or shortcuts, resistance to one' s true self, stagnation, the need for letting go and moving forward



11.JUSTICE

Information:

Element: Air

Astrology: Libra

Keywords: Fairness, judgment, truth, responsibility, balance

Interpretation:

The arbiter of justice raises the sword of judgment high beneath a solemn radiance, delivering impartial and resolute decisions. The austere courtroom, with its symmetrical structure, embodies seriousness and dignity. The sword, radiance, and scales form a stable triangular composition representing the balance and truth that the arbiter pursues. The majestic light pours down from above, signifying judgment based on a higher truth. The sword points straight upward, connecting to the radiance, symbolizing adherence to truth and an unbiased, fair judgment. The double-edged sword' s sharp blade carries duality—the power of judgment can either punish evil and uphold good or harm the innocent, all dependent on the arbiter' s intent. The scales are integrated into this double-edged sword, with weights measuring rationally to weigh pros and cons. The arbiter' s face is hidden behind the sword, not relying on eyes to see mere appearances but using insight

of the soul to discern essence, making balanced judgments while bearing the responsibility of decision-making.

Upright:

Correctness and rationality of matters, moderate balance, fairness and impartiality, personal virtues such as credibility, harmony, affirmative answers, conformity to norms, self-discipline, effort yielding results,victory in competition, legitimacy

Reversed:

Incorrect decisions, misguided actions, illegality or corruption, loss of life' s direction or goals, imbalance in situations, unjust judgments, false accusations or grievances, stubbornness, prejudice, unfair treatment



12.THE HANGED MAN

Information:

Element: Water

Astrology: Neptune

Keywords: Sacrifice, Changed Perspective, Waiting, Introspection, Compassion

Interpretation:

Ginkgo leaves gently drift down as the Hanged Man hangs upside down from a branch, breaking free from the cocoon and unfolding wings in the midst of painful transformation. This process of emergence is a physical and spiritual purification. In this inverted posture, the Hanged Man quietly endures suffering,willingly sacrificing the present for growth. Through this dual refinement of body and spirit, a unique perspective reveals another side of the world and bears witness to diverse forms of life. The cocoon is connected to the tree that sustains life' s roots, and through this connection to the source of life, strength and rebirth are gained amid hardship. Bit by bit, as the bonds of the cocoon break and the beautiful wings spread wide, the Hanged Man perceives the revelation of life' s essence and feels the freedom of transformation. In this golden season of maturity, the falling ginkgo leaves sing the praise of a second chance at life.

Upright:

Unresolved issues, feeling constrained, sacrificing immediate interests for long-term gains, personal growth through trials, strong intuition, physical weakness, meditation and rest, introspection and listening to one's inner voice, viewing things from a new perspective, sacrifice

Reversed:

Going with the flow, lacking opinions, breaking free from constraints and gaining freedom, selfishness and neglect of others, avoiding major decisions, excessive giving or sacrifice, seeking help from others,surrendering to fate



13.DEATH

Information:

Element: Water

Astrology: Scorpio

Keywords: Ending, Transformation, Rebirth, Clearing, Purification

Interpretation:

Smoke rises from the mourning fire, drifting into the River Styx, where souls become like fish swimming slowly toward the other shore, carrying their attachments and longings for the living world. Near the fire,the bereaved weeps, unaware that Death’ s knight silently stands beside her. This Death does not bring fear; instead, it gently rests a hand on her shoulder, warmly accepting and guiding the departing souls,comforting both her sorrow and their regrets.

By Death’ s side, a white horse bows its head in quiet reverence for the passing of life. Its body forms a barrier like a mountain range separating the realms of the living and the dead. Behind them, a fluttering banner points toward the direction of the underworld. Beyond the mountains, in the distant horizon, the rising sun pierces the darkness, shining a light of hope for new beginnings. Death is inevitable but not truly

an end; the conclusion of one journey marks the start of another.

As tears dry within the swirling smoke, she gradually accepts separation. True growth often requires letting go of the past and learning to find strength in farewell and renewal.

Upright:

Death, destruction, the end of old things and the beginning of new ones, the conclusion of an important phase, unemployment, new transformation, evolution, a transitional period from lower to higher levels,release, sublimation

Reversed:

Unable to move forward, fear of change, inability to accept transformation, escaping reality, loss of hope,negative mental state and lifestyle, post-traumatic stress disorder, feelings of helplessness, self-denial,pain



14.TEMPERANCE

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Sagittarius

Keywords: Regulation, Purification, Moderation, Unity, Growth

Interpretation:

Half mechanical, half flesh and blood, this figure balances reason and emotion, harmonizing opposing forces amid a tranquil iris garden. The precise structure of measuring instruments, with clear scales,controls the degree of desire down to the smallest fraction. The upright body is tall and graceful, with a single wing unfolded behind, symbolizing the soul' s sensitive nature. Two cups pour into each other,reflecting the subconscious and the delicate balance between gain and loss. The flowing liquid represents the exchange between emotion and thought, the communication and fusion of spirit and matter. The centripetal circular composition, echoing the symbol for gold, hints at the spiritual and psychic energies manifesting within the physical body. Surrounded by irises, the figure stands in a serene, harmonious atmosphere, embodying the state achieved by reconciling inner contradictions and attaining balance.

Upright:

A balanced, stable, and harmonious environment, self-improvement and purification, a gentle and comfortable pace of life, good interaction and communication, integration and unity, spiritual and mental elevation, inner self-regulation, recovery and healing

Reversed:

Division, disagreement, disharmony, imbalance, indulgence, lack of self-discipline, procrastination, lack of planning, loss of direction, lack of focus and patience, conflicts or even hostility in relationships,avoidance of reality, difficulty in communication



15.THE DEVIL

Information:

Element: Earth

Astrology: Capricorn

Keywords: Temptation, Bondage, Dependency, Desire, Addiction, Instinct

Interpretation:

Bathed in the glow of flames, the Devil' s hand raises the forbidden fruit of Eden, dripping with irresistible desire. In this silent evil, it summons humanity' s frantic pursuit. People see only the outstretched arm,unaware that the Devil' s form lurks in the shadows, oblivious to the danger hidden behind the temptation.From a cracked fissure, the Devil' s eye peers out, watching them ominously as they step toward the abyss. Flames burn everywhere, fueled by uncontrolled desire, while a massive pentagram glimmers in the firelight—chaotic and dark forces urging them deeper into a maze of lust and degradation.

Look at them: wings, tails, and horns of the Devil manifest. Entwined by vines and tendrils, they could easily break free but do not struggle; the bindings tighten as they fixate entirely on the tempting for bidden fruit. This is bondage they willingly embrace.

Upright:

Temptation, desire, the dark side of human nature, indulgence, lack of restraint, addiction, hedonism,materialism, strong desire for control, pursuit of fame and profit, being trapped, falling into difficulties,primal beast instincts, inner emptiness, corruption

Reversed:

Breaking free from shackles, escaping restraints, positive spiritual guidance, inner awakening, self-reflection and transformation, suppressed desires and instincts, personal spiritual independence, freeing from negative influences, freedom



16.THE TOWER

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Mars

Keywords: Destruction, Disaster, Release, Sudden Change, Renewal

Interpretation:

Destruction arrives! Under a dark, oppressive sky, only the lightning and fiery rain of calamity flash and fall. Twenty-two streams of relentless fire descend, embodying transformative power, striking the world densely. The divine punishment crashes down as thunder, shaking heaven and earth with immense force—an abrupt force an abrupt.unavoidable catastrophe that no one can escape or resist, bringing devastating impact and fundamental change.

The tower, once standing tall and proud, symbolizing enduring order and unshakable faith, crumbles the instant lightning strikes. It is ruthlessly torn apart, shattered into fragments that fall to the ground and dissolve into dust. Those who stood arrogantly at its heights are cast out into helplessness, unable to cope or recover, forced to surrender their struggle against collapse and disaster. Destruction comes—face the shock

and transformation head-on.

Upright:

Unpredictable, sudden disasters, the end of a relationship, unavoidable conflict or disputes, great challenges, loss; suffering, reckoning, strong external shocks, insecurity and anxiety

Reversed:

Destruction is less severe than upright, lesser oppression or bondage, a turbulent period, new changes and opportunities, the situation is manageable, underlying tensions, inner avoidance or procrastination



17.THE STAR

Information:

Element: Air

Astrology: Aquarius

Keywords: Hope, Inspiration, Healing, Guidance, Peace

Interpretation:

Under the serene night sky, a brilliant cluster of stars twinkles with the light of hope. They shine bright and distant, whispering of inspiration and the blossoming of life force. In the distance, a great water-bearer pours forth the waters of life, which flow gently along the night, extending into a stream of the subconscious. This flowing water becomes the source of emotional and creative energy, nurturing the vibrant grass and saplings by the water’ s edge, fostering their vigorous growth. The rippling stream reflects the sky and the floating stars’ shadows—the eight eight-pointed stars, seven large and one small,celebrate stability and blessings, revealing cosmic insights through their numbers. Upon the largest floating star, a figure emerges—born from the subconscious life of the stars—standing radiant like the star’ s own glow. Is this the spiritual form of the self, or hope crystallized from divine guidance?

Upright:

Hope and vision, a bright future, purification and peace, manifestation of the subconscious, listening to inner needs, filled with hope and confidence, physical healing, spiritual and inner growth, guidance,harmony

Reversed:

Hope dashed, unrealistic expectations or fantasies, weakness, fear, helplessness, depression and inability to release negative emotions, physical and mental exhaustion, loss of confidence, self-doubt and mistrust of others, despair, frustration, and low self-esteem



18.THE MOON

Information:

Element: Water

Astrology: Pisces

Keywords: Illusion, Subconscious, Confusion, Intuition, Deception, Anxiety

Interpretation:

Beneath the full moon, the dense darkness of the forest extends endlessly along a winding path, leading deeper into an enigmatic realm of illusion. The howls of two dogs echo in instinctive alarm, dreading the immense lunar disk and the terrors concealed beyond the twin towers. Reflected in the water are the twin towers, bearing an aura of death and the unknown, standing upright beside the path ahead. The moonitself is unseen in the sky; only its magnified shadow looms over the surface of the water. This watery moon is a false image, imbued with both allure and eeriness, blurring the line between illusion and reality.

The traveler steps upon the moon’ s reflection, stirring the water with raindrops and mist, rippling layers of subconscious agitation and emotional turbulence. What they tread upon is an illusion, never reaching the true celestial moon. In this shadowed night, all beings exist at the boundary

of illusion and reality, never fully awakening.

Upright:

Restlessness, confusion, fear, being energetic at night with a tendency to overthink, yielding to external influences, going with the flow, hidden matters, suppressed emotions, psychological shadows, projections from the deep subconscious, abundant creative inspiration

Reversed:

Disconnected from the subconscious, hidden matters surface and become clearer, facing reality,emotional outbursts and release, getting through a low phase, turning points appear, emerging from lies and deception, gaining insight into the truth



19.THE SUN

Information:

Element: Fire

Astrology: Sun

Keywords: Joy, Achievement, Energy, Clarity, Light, Celebration

Interpretation:

In a world filled with radiant light, sunflowers, the traveler, and the young horse all face the sun,expressing their love and devotion freely. The traveler holds a banner of celebration and joy, standing before a wall, reaching enthusiastically toward the sun. The lively white colt, just carrying the traveler as they leap over the wall' s confines, now approaches with bright, pure, and spiritual eyes gazing at the sun.Within the garden protected by the wall, the sunflowers turn their blooms toward the light and warmth,thriving vibrantly as they seek this dazzling brilliance and energy.

Where is the sun? Though unseen in this light-filled scene, all things convey the answer — the sun is you.You possess light, joy, and vitality. You bring sunshine, life, happiness, and success. The world shines brightly because of you, and in return, joy and flourishing energy flow back to you.

Upright:

Active vitality, full of life and growth, genuine happiness, abundant energy, smooth progress in various life areas such as career success, fulfilling relationships, healthy social interactions, and helpful mentors,spend time in the sun

Reversed:

Poor physical condition, low morale, excessive ambition, dissatisfaction with the current situation,impatience for quick results, overall still successful, encountering temporary setbacks, excessive enthusiasm, caution needed regarding unknown risks



20.JUDGEMENT

Information:

Element: Fire, Water

Astrology: Pluto

Keywords: Resurrection, Awakening, Turning Point, Judgment, Rebirth

Interpretation:

The layered clouds on the horizon gradually form the figure of Gabriel, whose trumpet sound pierces heaven and earth, announcing that the day of judgment has arrived—the moment of ending and new beginning. The distant sun casts a faint light, uncertain whether it is rising or setting, symbolizing both an ending and the rebirth that follows. Threads of light cloak the world in a mysterious solemnity at this pivotal moment. Beings emerge from the earth, reaching toward the sky to embrace this crucial turning point, ready to accept the soul' s examination and purification. The Fool, having journeyed far, witnesses the arrival of judgment just before the destination, stepping into a key stage of their journey. Paper boats drift slowly, about to merge into the vast ocean. Streams flowing from a book lead into the distance,connecting the present with the end, and narrating the spirit' s path to maturity. Each step of accumulation turns into

the power to arrive, awakening the soul toward breakthrough.

Upright:

The arrival of a new phase, bidding farewell to the old and welcoming the new, decisions of greatsignificance, entering a higher dimension or level, receiving deserved rewards, crucial turning points in life,reviewing the past to gain new insights

Reversed:

Stubbornness, resistance to change, efforts unrewarded, falling into self-doubt, indecisiveness, lackingjudgment, unwillingness to make choices, forced disconnection or ending of a relationship, suffering the consequences of one' s actions



21.THE WORLD

Information:

Element: Earth

Astrology: Saturn

Keywords: Completion, Integration, Achievement, Wholeness, Harmony

Interpretation:

The figure stands between heaven and earth, feeling the layered high clouds and the boundless water. Acircular laurel wreath appears behind them, symbolizing the perfect completion of this ethereal journey.They lay down their backpack and stretch in a world where time stands still. A faithful white dog watches a newborn puppy, their poses forming nearly a circle, representing both the fulfillment of this journey and the cycle of renewal. The once young bird has grown and now spreads its wings before the laurel wreath in the clouds, flying toward a higher existence; where the backpack once rested is now the nest of the new chick. The wilted flower in hand carries away the past, while new sprouts emerge on the water’ s surface, signaling the continuation of life and the birth of new hope.

Their mission is complete. Through this poetic and ethereal journey, they have realized the truth of

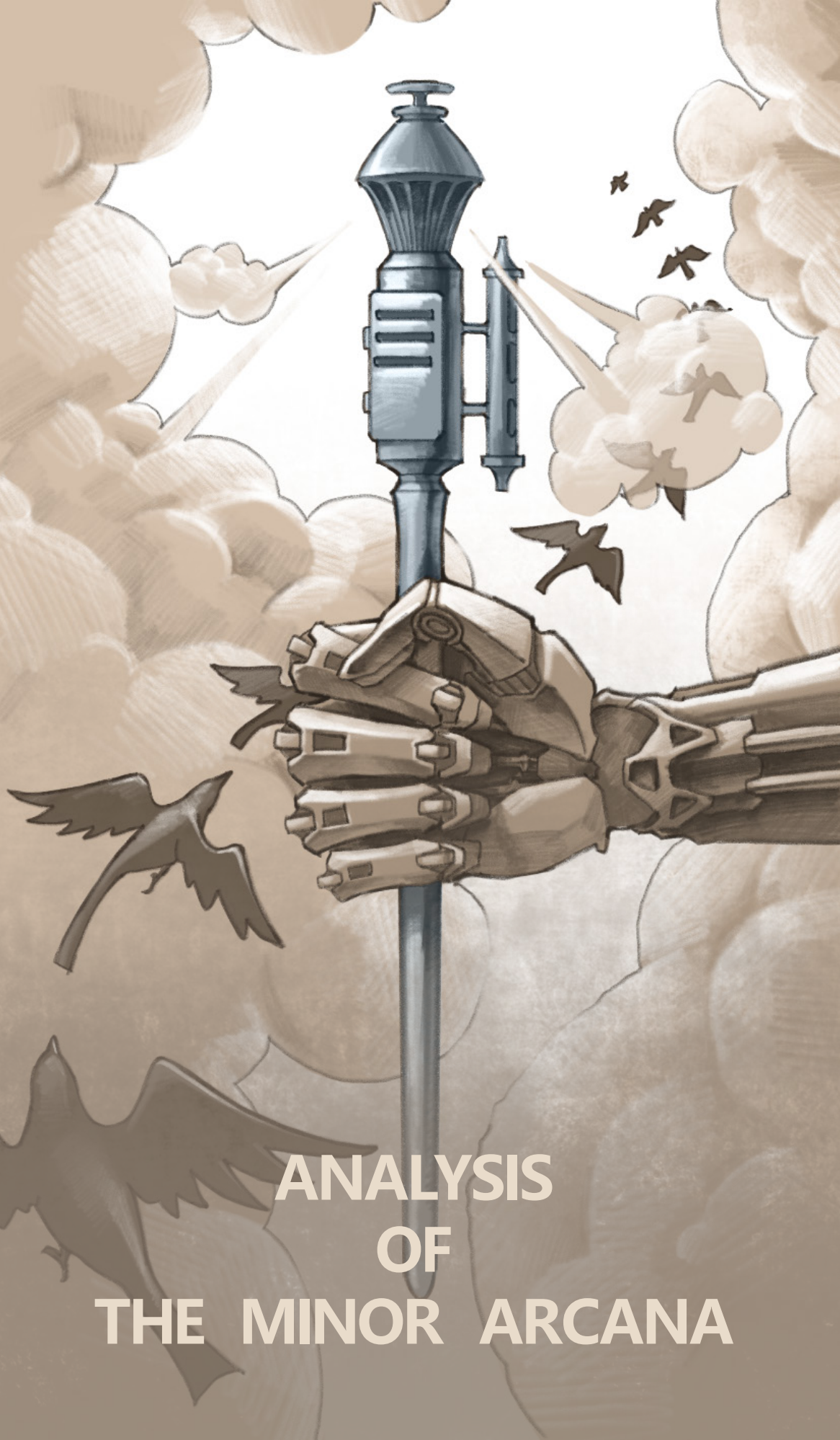
the world: life is unending, energy constantly flows, and the journey transcends within the cycle. The fulfilled existence grants meaning.

Upright:

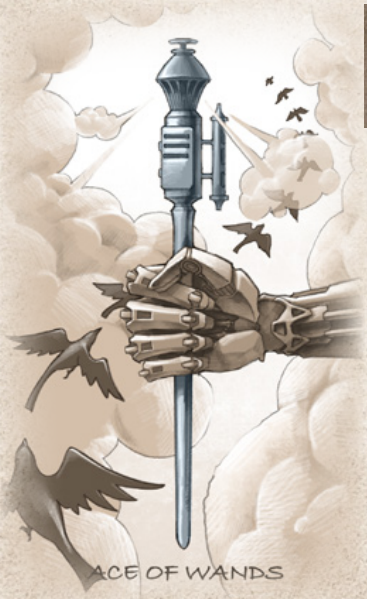
Natural completion, ultimate victory and a perfect ending, new beginnings, cycles, harmony between heaven and earth, long-distance travel, relocation, immigration, enlightenment, connection between the individual self and the universe, achievement

Reversed:

Stagnation, maintaining the status quo, delays in matters, lacking key elements or information, being justone step away from success, interruptions or obstacles in progress, imperfect endings, incomplete things



ANALYSIS OF THE MINOR ARCANA



ACE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

In the distant steampunk mechanical kingdom, there is a prince of telescopes who yearns for the stars.Bold and passionate, he is filled with an intense desire to realize his dreams. Grasping the wand tightly in his hand, its core radiates overwhelming heat, releasing bursts of steam. A grand plan begins with such strength and detemination.

Upright:

A powerful beginning, a desire for new plans, strength and courage, actions already underway, a promising future, an ideal time for practical endeavors, tangible actions, new opportunities

Reversed:

Failure in action, difficulties, obstacles or delays, lack of planning, carelessness, loss of motivation,insufficient independence, weakened willpower, a fragile sense of self, self-denial



TWO OF WANDS

Interpretation:

The prince often sits on a bench, gazing at the distant stars. While the mechanical creatures enjoy a leisurely existence in harmony with nature, the prince's ambitions extend far beyond. One day, with a telescope in hand, he made a decision that would shake the kingdom to its core: it was time to embark on a journey to explore the stars.

Upright:

Significant choices, planning and outlining, duality and the process of choice and balance, evaluation of options, preliminary preparations, noticeable bias

Reversed:

Ceasing evaluation and selection to move to the next phase and begin practical action, impulsive decisions without thorough consideration, events unfolding beyond control



THREE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

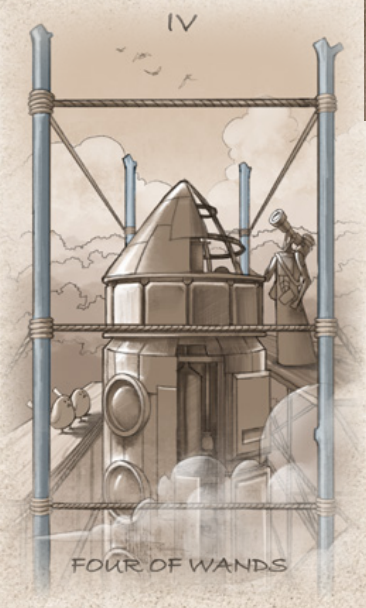
The prince begins preparing for his journey. He gathers tools and materials, carefully assembling his vehicle bit by bit. Inspired by his determination, the prince's friends rally to support him, and with collective effort, the construction progresses smoothly.

Upright:

Forward-looking measures and decisions, achieving initial success, turning plans into actionable steps,developing while consolidating the foundation, collaboration and mutual benefit, travel or business trips.

Reversed:

Reevaluating choices, plans obstructed or unrealized, outcomes falling short of expectations, arrogance or overconfidence, increased risks, avoiding partnerships



FOUR OF WANDS

Interpretation:

Sturdy scaffolding surrounds and supports the completed rocket, standing tall as a vessel for future journeys. Each component is securely and systematically connected. The prince's grand plan is now on track, allowing him a moment of relief to continue advancing steadily.

Upright:

Celebration and festivity, a stable living or family environment, a serene rural lifestyle, the pursuit of balance and stability, happiness, achievement, and ritual, rewards for hard work

Reversed:

A stable state is disrupted, conflicts arise with others, things are not as good as they seem, superficially harmonious relationships, inner anxiety, feeling isolated and unsupported, lack of security



FIVE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

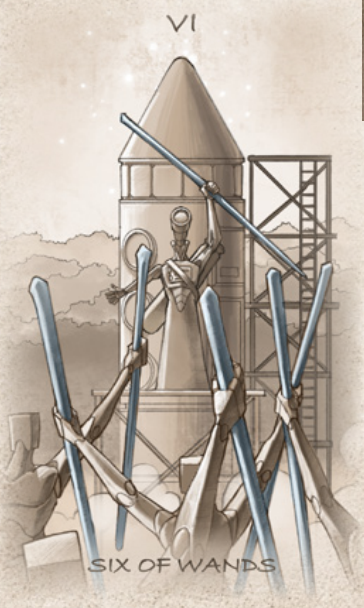
Building the rocket was not without setbacks. The intricate network of pipes and circuits inside often became a source of trouble, with birds and squirrels occasionally causing disruptions. The prince had to dedicate extra effort, crawling inside the rocket to inspect and repair it.

Upright:

Conflicts and disagreements with others, clashing perspectives or ideas, debates and arguments, fair competition, cultural exchanges, excessive self-awareness.

Reversed:

Resolution of conflicts, reconciliation and solutions, alignment of ideas and cooperation, increased chaos and intensified internal strife, deceitful actions, legal disputes



SIX OF WANDS

Interpretation:

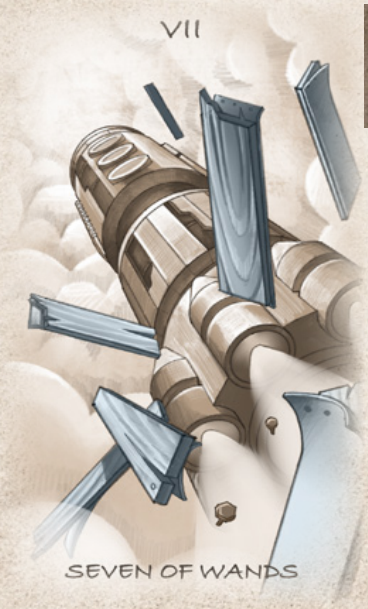
After a year of hard work, the rocket was finally completed. Cheers erupted as everyone celebrated the achievement. The prince stood proudly in front of the rocket, enthusiastically accepting the admiration of the crowd. This was the first rocket of the mechanical kingdom, marking a monumental success born of collective effort.

Upright:

Recognition and praise, promotion and financial rewards, significant progress or improvement in certain areas, good news, reaching a peak in work or life, strong self-confidence

Reversed:

Lack of confidence or wavering beliefs, actions not recognized or supported by others, damage to reputation, betrayal or isolation, setbacks and failure



SEVEN OF WANDS

Interpretation:

With blessings from the people, the rocket launched, heading towards new challenges. The prince aimed for distant stars, riding the rocket into the unknown. Fierce winds stripped away parts of the outer shell,and failing components tried to hinder the journey. Yet, the prince remained fearless.

Upright:

Obstacles on the path forward, often multiple, strong competitiveness, exceptional personal strength,determination and courage, holding a position of advantage, confidence, a love for challenges

Reversed:

Anxiety and indecision, difficulty adapting to new environments, exhaustion due to overwork, instability in surroundings and circumstances, clarity for outsiders but confusion for the individual, blocked actions



EIGHT OF WANDS

Interpretation:

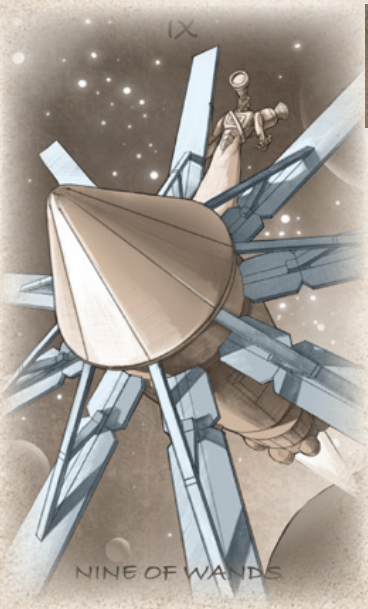
The rocket, fueled by immense energy, pierced through the clouds and escaped the planet's pull,entering the vastness of space. The prince witnessed the brilliance of the stars, the surging sea of clouds,and celestial bodies moving in their orbits. A new world unfolded before him, and he felt boundless freedom on his dream journey.

Upright:

Rapid progress, the arrival of new developments, swift movement, unhindered advancement, imminent outcomes for anticipated events, progress in previously delayed matters

Reversed:

Stagnation and lack of advancement, confusion and disorder, insufficient preparation, leading to missed opportunities, fleeting enthusiasm and lack of sustained action, unwillingness to take responsibility



NINE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

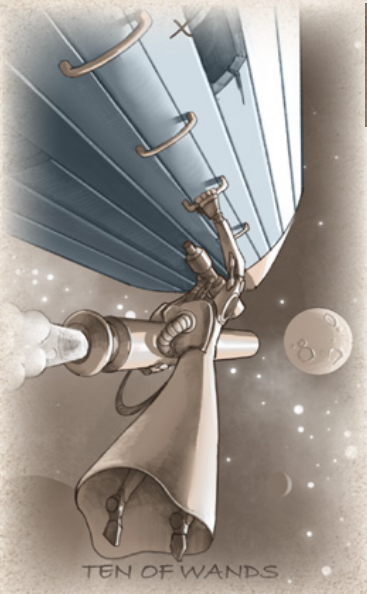
After witnessing the vastness of the starry seas, the prince felt a sense of exhaustion and helplessness.He reflected on the details of his star-chasing journey. The desolate depths of space, fraught with danger,sparked his intense unease. Steering his rocket, the prince deployed shields to defend against meteors and radiation, standing resilient against the cosmic challenges.

Upright:

Defensiveness due to past harm, heightened mental tension, facing life's challenges and tests, relentless efforts leading to success, experiences of betrayal

Reversed:

Excessive anxiety and paranoia, harming others in self-defense, lack of security, situations exceeding one’ s capacity to handle, stagnation and waiting for a better opportunity



TEN OF WANDS

Interpretation:

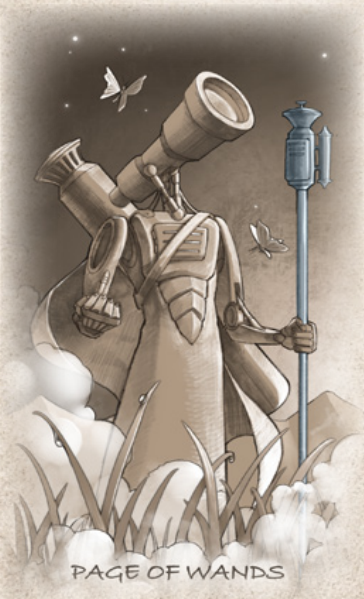
The rocket' s energy was entirely depleted, and the prince, burdened beyond measure, jettisoned the fuel reserves. Sacrificing his life, he used his final strength to propel the broken rocket toward the last star.Eventually, the prince and the rocket' s wreckage became a shooting star, silently fading into a distant corner of the universe.

Upright:

Harvest and accomplishments, bearing excessive stress and responsibility, additional tasks and labor,inability to refuse requests, leading to overburdened duties

Reversed:

Overwhelming responsibilities reaching a breaking point, unbearable stress leading to collapse,excessive workload, relinquishing unnecessary burdens and duties



PAGE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

Beneath the night sky, the Telescope Prince gazed at the starry sea. With youthful fervor, he longed to one day reach the center of the cosmos. Before long, he channeled his passion into igniting a monumental initiative in the Steam Kingdom, boldly embarking on an unprecedented journey of challenge and discovery.

Upright:

Boundless enthusiasm and drive, exploration of new domains, learning, and analysis, encountering fascinating subjects, passion and vitality, adaptability and flexibility

Reversed:

Distracted and unable to focus, inexperience causing delays, immaturity, lack of foresight leading to significant losses, aimlessness, fatigue and disinterest



KNIGHT OF WANDS

Interpretation:

The Telescope Knight piloted his rocket with immense power, propelling himself into the cosmos.Impulsive yet determined, this young pioneer personally built the rocket, enabling him to witness uncharted landscapes never before seen by his kin. Back in the homeland, he had become a legend of the Steam Mechanical Kingdom.

Upright:

Strong desire for exploration, fearless and adventurous spirit, entering new environments or domains,skilled executioner with knowledge and expertise, enthusiasm and vigor

Reversed:

Recklessness and impatience leading to missed opportunities, lack of experience causing errors,impulsive actions with unconsidered consequences, anger and disputes with others



QUEEN OF WANDS

Interpretation:

The Microscope Queen, mother of the prince, was passionate, straightforward, and independent. Bold and exploratory, she utilized her internal microscope to observe the world in meticulous detail. Steam emitted from her shoulders as she confidently embraced her boundless energy and passion, venturing boldly into the unknown.

Upright:

Harmony between thought and action, captivating and charismatic, optimistic and cheerful with boundless energy, strong leadership without being overbearing, approachable and amiable

Reversed:

Quick-tempered and aggressive, deceit and infidelity, prone to jealousy and sharp words, increased need for control, insecurity and a lack of self-discipline



KING OF WANDS

Interpretation:

The Mechanical Hand King, father of the prince, was a towering figure of strength. His core steam furnace burned with intense flames, generating unparalleled power. With this energy, the king skillfully operated his mechanical arms, relishing challenges. Under his rule, the kingdom thrived in orderly prosperity.

Upright:

Exceptional creativity and leadership, inspiring creativity in others, active, straightforward, andcharismatic; confident, bold, and fearless

Reversed:

Poor management and inability to allocate resources effectively, misuse or abuse of power, overly subjective and unable to see issues clearly, lack of strength and ability



ACE OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

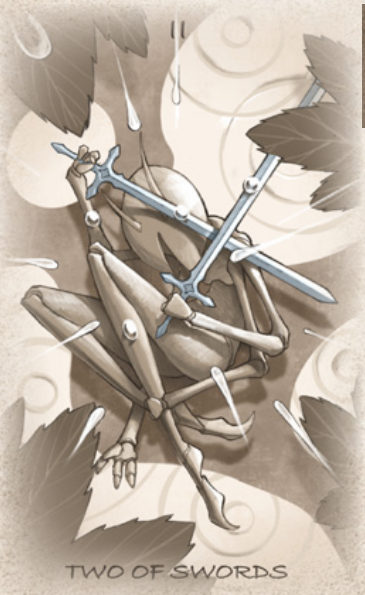
The swordsman grips the inherited blade tightly in both hands. The gleaming edge emits a chilling radiance, filled with an aura of solemnity and destruction. A tattered cloak reflects a history of hardship and pain. The sharp blade pierces through a crown, symbolizing a resolute decision made with clarity—one that carries the potential to harm both self and others, yet also serves as an act of redemptive destruction.

Upright:

A new perspective or development, breakthroughs, intellect and insight, uncovering deception and seeking truth, strong communication skills, clarity, mental sharpness, and agility

Reversed:

Facing challenges or difficulties, arguments and disputes, miscommunication or breakdown in dialogue,verbal attacks (intentional or unintentional), destructive actions, lack of clarity in goals



TWO OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

Long ago, there lived an unnamed swordsman. Among its kin, it was noticeably smaller than its peers. Its fragile frame fostered self-doubt and a cautious view of the world. Curling beneath a leaf, its hat brim obscuring its face, it clutched two swords to shield itself from the cold indifference of the world.

Upright:

Self-defense, facing inner dilemmas, caught in a difficult decision, a mindset of avoidance or challenge,striving for balance between opposing forces, inner conflict making decisions hard, hesitation

Reversed:

The need to make a decision, ending indecisiveness and confronting problems, inner turmoil creating confusion, external complications affecting judgment



THREE OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

Conflict and sacrifice are merciless realities among all species, and the swordsman' s kin are no exception. Wars frequently broke out between tribes over resources and territory, leading to rivers of blood. The swordsman' s beloved elder brother, the tribe' s strongest knight, sacrificed his life to save it.

Upright:

Sorrow, grief, and pain, emotional wounds, periods of immense pressure, depression, verbal or intellectual harm, potential for future hurt

Reversed:

Gradual healing from past wounds, recovering from heartache, unhealed scars, lingering over past painand refusing to face the present



FOUR OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

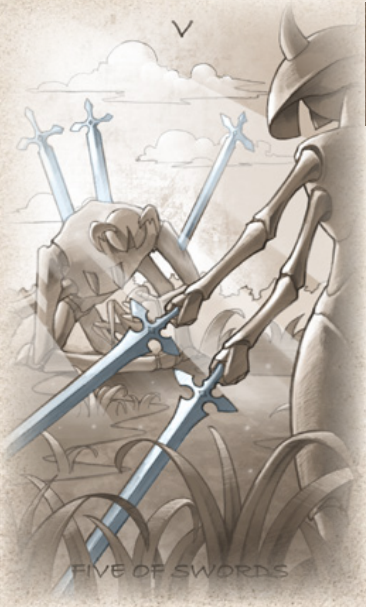
The loss of the elder brother dealt a devastating blow to the swordsman, leaving it despondent. Dim light filtered through a narrow window, elongating shadows and freezing time. Retreating into a cocoon of sorrow, the exhausted swordsman sought solace, allowing its energy to slowly regenerate for the journey ahead.

Upright:

Rejuvenation and replenishment, recovering energy while awaiting the right moment, physical healing,pausing current projects or activities, opportunities for rest and recovery, temporary retreat

Reversed:

Restarting and moving forward, renewed energy after adequate rest, recognizing the right timing,overworking or failing to rest adequately, physical and mental strain



FIVE OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

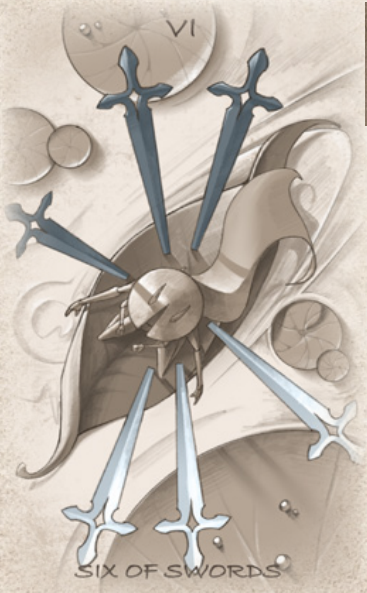
The wars between tribes were always unjust. Victorious factions reveled in their fleeting triumph,plundering resources for temporary prosperity but losing much more in the process. The endless human chaos snuffed out the brilliance of souls, and unscrupulous victories proved ultimately meaningless.

Upright:

Conflict, separation, or loss, disputes involving multiple parties, being drawn into a conflict, disagreements or differences in opinions with others, unlawful competition

Reversed:

Tense situations are nearing resolution, opportunities for communication in disputes arise, readjustment of one' s mindset, chances for change or discovering a new direction, reversal of circumstances



SIX OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

The grief of losing the elder brother pierced the swordsman' s heart like a blade embedded in a fragile boat. Drenched in sorrow, the swordsman set out despite its pain, floating over calm waters. Surrounded by swords offering both protection and peril, the journey held uncertainty but also faint glimmers of hope.

Upright:

Water travel or sailing, smooth communication and unimpeded thoughts, healing after chaos, gradually regaining oneself, withdrawal from social circles, stressful environments, relocation

Reversed:

Overwhelmed by emotions, unable to heal, disruptions such as capsizing, turbulent recovery process,resistance to change worsening emotional states, oppressive surroundings; breakdown



SEVEN OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

The swordsman infiltrates the enemy camp to steal the swords that once harmed its kin. It believes disarming the enemy will force a temporary ceasefire. Alone, it cannot carry all the weapons, and some swords are left behind during the escape. This risky maneuver may create greater threats in its wake.

Upright:

Taking shortcuts or resorting to cunning, compensating for lack of strength with unconventional methods,theft; employing any means to achieve a goal, dishonesty and deceit

Reversed:

Letting go of old ways of thinking, embracing a new mindset, ceasing self-deception or deception of others, exposure of improper actions leading to consequences, reliance on luck



EIGHT OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

On the way back, the swordsman strays into a treacherous swamp and falls prey to a botanical trap. Though the vines entangle it, they do not tighten. Swords lie scattered nearby, one within reach. Yet fear paralyzes the swordsman, leaving it unable to resist or struggle.

Upright:

Actions restricted, trapped in an oppressive environment, fear preventing acknowledgment of the truth,self-imposed limitations, rigid and constrained thinking

Reversed:

Gaining inner strength and clarity, breaking free from constraints and resuming action, confronting personal truths, escaping oppressive situations, newfound enlightenment



NINE OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

After narrowly escaping danger, the swordsman is plagued by relentless nightmares. In its bleak dreams,it relives its most painful memories, including the moment its brother died before its eyes. Again and again, sunsets mark irreversible losses. The recurring torment robs the swordsman of rest, breaking its spirit.

Upright:

Excessive inner worry and anxiety, insomnia and poor sleep quality, nightmares; deep emotional distress and despair, lack of security

Reversed:

Intuition brought by dreams, lingering in the past, the return of anxieties or painful emotions, doubt in external circumstances, immense pressure from the environment



TEN OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

The war erupts anew, repeating the bloody tragedies of the past. When children are once again endangered, the swordsman steps forward without hesitation. Like its elder brother, it shields others from the blade of death with its own body. In its final moments, it uses its remaining strength to safeguard the future of its kin.

Upright:

Enduring a period of pain and despair, the conclusion of a situation, condition, or relationship, hitting rock bottom before a breakthrough, the darkest hour before dawn, with hope just ahead

Reversed:

Problems temporarily receding, gradual recovery from trauma, persistent but diminished suffering, finding a brief respite within current difficulties



PAGE OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

As a youth, the swordsman dreamed of becoming a brave knight like its elder brother. Though its slender frame made it cautious and wary of the world, it possessed natural sharpness and agility of thought. It understood that, beyond strength, nimbleness of mind was equally vital.

Upright:

Being in a challenging environment, gaining new perspectives or important information, keen observation and insight, strong logical and analytical abilities, being well-informed and resourceful

Reversed:

Excessive vigilance and defensiveness, pronounced distrust or paranoia, difficulty expressing oneself,possibly due to nervousness or stuttering, scattered thoughts leading to poor decisions, spreading gossip or rumors



KNIGHT OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

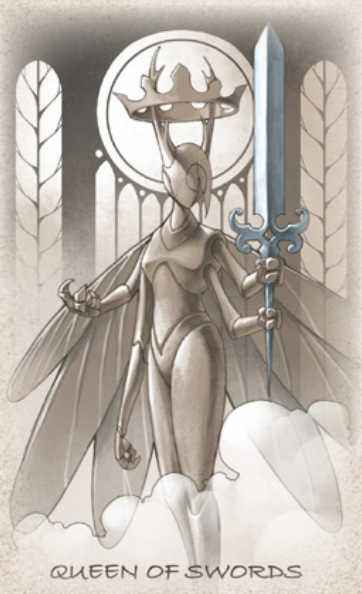
The swordsman' s elder brother was the tribe' s mightiest knight, renowned for his courage and decisiveness. Though impulsive, he was awe-inspiring. He once tamed a giant bird that preyed on the tribe, transforming it into his steed. On the battlefield, he rode like the wind, leaving behind countless legends.

Upright:

Swift and decisive action; rushing into a new phase or situation with urgency; reckless but powerful energy; impulsive and impatient; acting with great intensity and force

Reversed:

Overreaching or lacking the capability to achieve one' s ambitions, failure due to poor planning or rashness, reckless behavior causing harm, susceptibility to external pressures or volatile emotions,carelessness



QUEEN OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

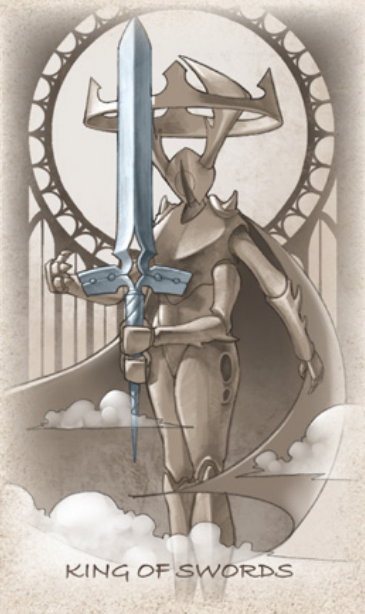
The queen of the enemy tribe was a formidable swordswoman, skilled not only in combat but also renowned for her intellect. She orchestrated numerous attacks on the swordsman' s tribe, commanding with precision and cold efficiency akin to the edge of a blade. Her thoughtful governance inspired both fear and admiration.

Upright:

Clear thinking and rational intelligence, excellent document or communication skills, wise and competent,exceptional insight and fairness in judgment, objective evaluation of situations

Reversed:

Overly rational and blunt, possibly hurting others with words, exuding a strong sense of oppression,overly strict or demanding, rigid and inflexible in beliefs, independent to a fault



KING OF SWORDS

Interpretation:

The king of the swordsman' s tribe was a celebrated military strategist known for his exceptional wisdom,composure, and judgment. Proficient in swordsmanship and courageous in battle, he was also a rational and strategic ruler. His steady leadership and calculated strategies made him a pillar of trust and a symbol of wisdom among his people.

Upright:

Integrity, sharpness, applying wisdom and judgment to practical issues, viewing problems from an objective perspective while maintaining rational thinking, a benefactor capable of providing crucial guidance

Reversed:

Loss of clear thinking, inability to control one's mind, lack of perseverance leading to failure in implementing plans, extreme rationality, strong desire to criticize, arrogance



ACE OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The messenger of the swamp holds up a sacred chalice, from which crystal-clear dewdrops gently fall,creating tiny ripples that nurture a pure white blossom. The awakened petals unfurl, flourishing under the dew' s life-giving essence. Emotional resonance flows, connecting hearts. Within the gentle, joyous mist, anew story begins to unfold.

Upright:

The beginning of a new emotional journey or relationship, improving interpersonal connections, sensitivity to surroundings and rich inner feelings, creative and artistic inclinations, heightened emotional awareness and receptivity

Reversed:

Excessive emotionality leading to a loss of control or irrationality, emotional and spiritual emptiness,broken relationships or severed connections, suppressed feelings nearing a breaking point, overwhelming maternal instincts



TWO OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The messenger of rain descends, meeting the swamp messenger. They are drawn together by an inexplicable harmony. Between the shadows of clouds and ripples of water, they converse joyfully—rain recounting tales of distant lands, while the swamp responds with serene waves. Their chance meeting deepens into genuine connection, resonating in their hearts.

Upright:

Equal and communicative interpersonal relationships, balanced energy formed through mutual complementarity, mutual attraction between both parties, the beginning of a healthy romantic relationship,deeper connections with a partner

Reversed:

Breakdown of a partnership, separation, arguments or conflicts, unequal relationships with imbalanced contributions, one party being overly dominant, breakup, emotional rift



THREE OF CUPS

Interpretation:

Rain takes the swamp messenger out of its long-secluded dwelling into the vast mountains. Together,they explore, making new friends along the way. Through shared laughter and conversation, the swamp messenger experiences a long-missed joy, discovering the richness and diversity of the world through companionship.

Upright:

Social activities, group gatherings or parties, celebrations and harvest, stability, harmony, and balance in emotional and social relationships, triangular interpersonal relationships, making new friends

Reversed:

Excessive indulgence and deviation, breakdown and discord in team relationships, inability to reach a consensus with hidden agendas, the cycle of fullness and decline, joy turning to sorrow, overindulgence



FOUR OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The messenger of rain invites the swamp to leave the mountains, but the swamp lingers, lost in past thoughts. Though the journey with rain was full of wonder, it has left the swamp weary. Reluctant to embrace this new offer, the swamp withdraws, declining the rain's proposal.

Upright:

Dissatisfaction with past experiences or current foundations, self-imposed isolation and reluctance to engage with the outside world, inner emptiness and rejection of new opportunities, feelings of confusion and discontent

Reversed:

Recognizing and seizing new opportunities, breaking free from stagnation and taking action, reigniting passion for life, progress in long-delayed matters



FIVE OF CUPS

Interpretation:

Rain departs with a hint of regret, leaving the swamp messenger to face its sorrow alone. Gazing at the familiar swamp, the messenger finds no solace in its homecoming. Regret for missed opportunities intertwines with guilt over its hesitation, as the swamp dwells on its inability to move forward.

Upright:

Grief and sorrow over a loss, feeling dejected due to past failures, emotional lows and lack of motivation,focusing solely on losses while ignoring what remains

Reversed:

Gradual recovery from past grief, reigniting hope for life, discovering new opportunities or second chances, healing after enduring emotional pain



SIX OF CUPS

Interpretation:

Returning to the swamp, the messenger finds solace in the presence of circling fish. Thoughts drift to the past, when it was a lively stream and its companion was a tiny fry. The flowing waters of their youth, filled with warmth and joy, linger in the memory. This sanctuary feels like a heartfelt refuge, steeped in nostalgia.

Upright:

Reflecting on past experiences, becoming entrenched in nostalgia and unable to move forward, yearning for the comfort of familiar places or relationships, staying within one' s safe zone, reconnecting with childhood innocence

Reversed:

Awakening from past attachments and stepping into new opportunities, venturing out of the comfort zone to embrace growth, planning for the future with renewed clarity, personal transformation and development



SEVEN OF CUPS

Interpretation:

In the swamp messenger' s dream, a hazy mist surrounds it, as if standing amidst vast clouds under an inverted sky. Ripples spread across the waters of emotion and the subconscious. Adventure, friends, self-discovery—inner desires take tangible form, appearing within reach yet remaining elusive and indistinct.

Upright:

Daydreaming and disconnection from reality, impractical ideas and unrealistic goals, an abundance of unfulfilled desires, rich imagination and artistic creativity, being overwhelmed by excessive wants

Reversed:

Letting go of unrealistic fantasies and focusing on practical efforts, awakening from illusions and confronting reality, realizing that progress might not align with initial expectations



EIGHT OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The swamp messenger finally resolves to leave behind the familiar mountains and venture into the unknown. Abandoning the comfort and stagnation of the past, it sets out with firm determination to seek the rain messenger. The messenger knows that only by moving forward can it discover the vastness of the world.

Upright:

A transition from external exploration to inner spiritual growth, abandoning past material attachments to uncover subconscious truths, a weariness of worldly concerns and a desire for solitude

Reversed:

Hesitation and indecision, remaining stagnant; an unwillingness to let go of material comforts or current realities, losing motivation and lacking direction for the future



NINE OF CUPS

Interpretation:

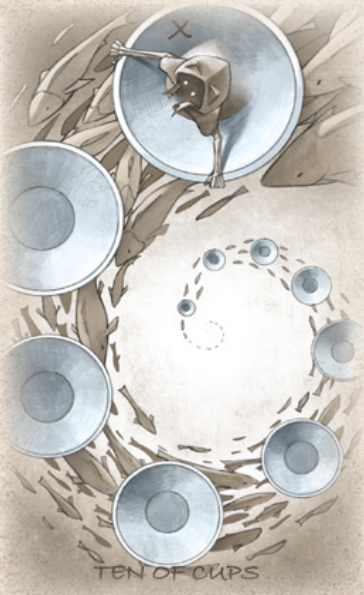
The swamp messenger journeys beyond the mountains, drifting toward the horizon. Fish gradually gather around it, accompanying it on its path. Each day is filled with laughter and friendship. The swamp messenger’ s deepest desires are fulfilled, and it revels in the journey, experiencing an unparalleled sense of happiness and contentment.

Upright:

Dreams come true and wishes fulfilled · self-satisfaction,pride, and a sense of accomplishment,displaying and flaunting one’ s achievements or wealth,seeking external validation and admiration

Reversed:

Losing hard-earned achievements or lacking external support,self-indulgence and inflated ego,greed and insatiable desires leading to self-destruction,being overly self-centered



TEN OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The fish surround the swamp messenger, carrying it forward. The messengers of water quietly converge,and the once-isolated swamp messenger finds itself in a thriving emotional connection. Immersed in harmony, it feels the joy of belonging. The fish form a river of time, their movements composing a symphony of fulfillment and wholeness.

Upright:

Strong emotional bonds within a group,harmonious and joyful group relationships,excellent teamwork and collaboration,feelings of completion and happiness,giving and receiving freely in balanced exchanges

Reversed:

Misunderstandings and fractures within group dynamics,feeling disconnected from others and unable to find joy in life' s offerings,conflicts and scheming within the team causing harm



PAGE OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The swamp messenger, accustomed to solitude, yearns for emotional connection. Its sensitive and intricate heart struggles to engage with others due to the memories buried in the swamp. Staring at the cup in its hands, the emblem of its watery identity quietly offers it gentle comfort.

Upright:

The arrival of a new relationship or collaboration,an intriguing new task or job, inspiration and artistic creativity,the receipt of good news; external generosity, the first blush of love

Reversed:

Emotional wounds,communication barriers,creativity and imagination blocked,excessive sensitivity,over-reliance on others,lack of empathy



KNIGHT OF CUPS

Interpretation:

The rain messenger journeys forward on a cloud, embodying gentleness and romance. Carrying overflowing emotions, it sculpts the mist into beautiful blossoms with its pure spirit. Distributing soft dew to the earth, it awakens dormant hearts through action, imparting warmth and a tender touch to the world.

Upright:

A deeply romantic relationship,a "prince charming" or ideal lover,progress in emotional matters,emotional intelligence,charm and allure,kindness and attentiveness

Reversed:

Emotional setbacks and entrapments,infidelity, unreliability, or disloyalty,exploiting others' affections for personal gain,insincere flattery or manipulation



QUEEN OF CUPS

Interpretation:

She is the embodiment of the sky. Her cup, gentle and kind as a sea of clouds, embraces the world. With an expansive heart, she accepts life' s fluctuations and tenderly nurtures all souls. Birds, carrying freedom and love, flock around her in joyous harmony.

Upright:

Highly empathetic and a good listener,sensitive and intuitive,spiritual growth and strong intuition,able to balance reason and emotion effectively

Reversed:

A lack of inspiration causing delays,potential interpersonal conflicts,losing control over emotions,leading to emotional breakdowns,overindulgence in fantasies, neglecting reality



KING OF CUPS

Interpretation:

He is the embodiment of the ocean. Beneath the waves, he opens pathways, gathering waters from all rivers to transform emotions into harmonious currents. Fish follow this emotional tide, carrying the messenger of waters to the deep and tranquil ocean floor. As the guardian of life' s source, he brings peace and profound meaning to all emotions.

Upright:

A harmonious blend of emotions, creativity, and inspiration,excellent social and communicative abilities,emotionally centered and stable,fostering balanced relationships

Reversed:

Chaotic interpersonal relationships,lack of control over emotions and creativity,manipulative behavior,unethical actions,deceit hidden behind a facade



ACE OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

On this magical land, people cultivate stars. At harvest time, the starry sea rises and the tide carries away the ripe stars. Visitors from beyond the sky pay the hardworking alchemists with pentacles. The story begins with the very first pentacle received by the conical flask.

Upright:

New opportunities, financial income, good news related to money and material matters, having enough material foundation to pursue your dreams, good financial luck; stable career or work

Reversed:

Financial losses, uncontrolled extravagance and waste, missed opportunities, inability to start new ventures, precarious financial state, failed investments; poor planning



TWO OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

The conical flask just started working and has reached its first harvest season. It carefully holds the first gathered stars, welcoming the first pentacle from the visitors beyond. Joy from the initial harvest mixes with reluctance to part with it, as the flask tries to find balance and adapt its rhythm.

Upright:

Duality and balance, decisions related to money, weighing pros and cons, juggling multiple directions,fluid energy, skillful management of resources and time

Reversed:

Inability to manage too many things at once, difficulty maintaining balance, chaotic energy, confusion over priorities, disorganized life



THREE OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

In the following days, the conical flask and its partners set a new cultivation plan. Each uses their skills to collaborate closely—some prune branches, others water and nurture, others harvest. Every step relies on mutual cooperation and support.

Upright:

Teamwork, cooperation, and role clarity, initial progress in work, shared goals, the process of implementing plans, business outsourcing, third-party introductions

Reversed:

Internal conflicts within the team, poor communication causing delays, unreasonable division of labor,progress hindered, incomplete planning



FOUR OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

The conical flask finally saved its first pot of gold. It tightly holds its pentacles, treasuring this formal wealth. Its attachment to money breeds fear of loss. Cautious about spending, it is unwilling to share and even reduces investment in cultivation.

Upright:

Stinginess, conservatism, excessive frugality, overvaluing material security while ignoring external information, investing primarily to recover or preserve capital

Reversed:

Greed, obsessive possessiveness over wealth, reckless spending and financial overspending, irrational financial management, financial crises



FIVE OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

Due to poor management, the conical flask faces a barren harvest and can only envy others celebrating their starry harvests while it returns empty-handed. Losing income leads to helplessness and depression.Hope turns into frustration during this poorest time.

Upright:

Financial hardship, health problems, poor economic conditions, unfavorable social environment, spiritual emptiness and loneliness, facing difficulties without support

Reversed:

End of hardship, turning misfortune into fortune, gradual recovery, opportunities for change approaching,breaking free from current constraints, feeling isolated and helpless



SIX OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

In their darkest hour, a visitor from the stars generously bestows a batch of pentacles upon the Flask Tribe. Grateful for the aid, they temporarily ease their material struggles and find the strength to continue forward. The flask understands that balance governs the distribution of this gift, emphasizing the importance of responsible allocation.

Upright:

Providing material help to others, receiving aid and support, charitable acts, and stable financial growth,It also signifies the transfer of knowledge and experience to others

Reversed:

The cessation of assistance from others, unfair treatment or favoritism, leading to unequal relationships,financial losses, overspending, and an imbalance in resources



SEVEN OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

With new funding, the Flask Tribe re-engages in star cultivation. Their diligent work yields abundant results as vibrant star trees flourish in the fields. Resting under the trees after the harvest, the flask reflects on the season' s achievements and contemplates future plans for their enterprise.

Upright:

Reflecting on future actions and strategies to ensure continued value and development. long-term goal setting and approaching rewards for effort, material gains and recognition

Reversed:

Dissatisfaction with the current state, feeling that efforts are not yielding expected returns, need to reevaluate strategies or seek new opportunities, potential setbacks and challenges



EIGHT OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

Diligently immersed in their work, the Flask Tribe focuses on perfecting cultivation techniques. To achieve long-term prosperity, they refine tools and develop more efficient methods. This breakthrough overcomes previous limitations, enabling precise and meticulous growth.

Upright:

Devoted effort toward learning new skills and deepening knowledge. A commitment to one' s craft and the pursuit of excellence, building upon past successes, scholarly spirit and focus

Reversed:

Overwork and neglect of rest or leisure, lack of the skills required to achieve current goals, losing sight of personal values in the pursuit of financial outcomes, perfectionism obstructing progress



ACE OF WANDS

Interpretation:

Nourished by the life-giving waters, the Flask Tribe experiences an unparalleled harvest, celebrated as ahistorical achievement. On the day of the harvest festival, the flask reclines in the star grove, admiring the bountiful results of its effort. The stars sway in the breeze, symbolizing the fulfillment that comes from hard work.

Upright:

A graceful and leisurely lifestyle, financial independence, confidence in personal success, enjoyment of material comforts, stress relief, and indulgence in relaxation or vacations

Reversed:

Lack of discipline or a desire for effortless wealth, overindulgence in luxuries and impulsive spending,financial risks, busy routines, overwhelming work-related stress



TEN OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

Pentacles flow like a perpetual tide, bringing wealth and happiness to the Flask Tribe. They achieve a life of abundance, passing their skills and fortune to the next generation. As the flask ages gracefully, their legacy echoes through time, becoming a legend of prosperity and endurance.

Upright:

Family cooperation, stable material foundation, enduring and lasting success, substantial financial income, secure and stable life but lacking emotional communication, inheritance of family business

Reversed:

Team discord, financial crisis, lack of a stable material foundation, plans hindered due to lack of funds,gambling, high-interest loans, bankruptcy, economic crisis



PAGE OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

The Page of Pentacles gently touches an unripe star, nurturing it with care. Through attentive cultivation,they witness its growth—a reward for their patience and effort. In nurturing the star, the Page also grows,gaining valuable knowledge and experience.

Upright:

A new beginning with clear and specific goals to pursue. It indicates focus on learning or work, acquiring new skills, receiving a gift, or starting a new plan

Reversed:

Lacking direction or purpose, making mistakes due to carelessness, irresponsibility, laziness, procrastination, indecision without concrete plan, not yet finding a true passion



KNIGHT OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

During another harvest season, a visitor from the stars comes to purchase the fruit of their labor. The Knight of Pentacles, holding a star, sits firmly as the celestial hand reaches out to lift it into the sky. The knight raises the star to meet the hand, contemplating what rewards it might bring.

Upright:

Pragmatic and steady, avoids excessive risks, stable and serious, acts with a plan, persistent mindset,values commitments, responsible, strong burst of energy, efficient

Reversed:

Loses direction, lazy and unwilling to act, overly cautious and conservative, inflexible, lacks motivation and initiative, stubborn, stuck in a rut



QUEEN OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

The Queen of Pentacles, a celestial ruler, gently supports the Knight of Pentacles as the star in their hands ascends, forming brilliant trails around her. Her figure radiates grace amidst the starry sea,embodying both the nurturing generosity of a maternal figure and regal authority.

Upright:

Careful and attentive, with a talent for caring for oneself and others, abundance, resourcefulness, and the ability to acquire needed resources, warmth, generosity, stable, secure relationships

Reversed:

An imbalance between work and personal life, leading to stress and pressure. Suggests losing direction,being trapped in unrealistic dreams, or experiencing self-doubt and a lack of confidence



KING OF PENTACLES

Interpretation:

The youthful Knight of Pentacles matures into a self-reliant King. Over time, he accumulates wealth,knowledge, and power. As he holds the Pentacle atop his world, his leadership revitalizes the land,bringing forth new life and brilliance.

Upright:

A crucial person; abundance in both material and spiritual aspects; practical attitude; holds certain social influence; has a flexible business mind; financially stable and wealthy; a benefactor

Reversed:

Greed, strong material desires; exploitation and oppression of others; unethical means; hypocrisy, ill intentions; clearly driven by self-interest; indulging in material pleasures

A LITTLE STORY

About the Major Arcana:

Every story has a protagonist. Perhaps a tarot deck, too, can carry a thread. The original theme of Ethereal Poetry is "memories beyond time," a phrase I first encountered in The Three-Body Problem. I wondered if, beyond this world, there might truly be drifting stories left forgotten. But stories must be read to be told. And so, the Fool was born. With a mechanical body, it journeys through countless tales, preserving them all in its memory units. We don't know how much its machine mind truly understands, but it has passed the stories along to you.

I want to create something different, something that could move you. So, the Magician opens himself up. The Emperor lifts a heavy crown. A squirrel takes up resi-

dence within the Hierophant. The Hanged Man is reborn from his cocoon. Death stands in awe of life. The Moon ripples across the water. And after all that, were you able to feel the warmth of the Sun? These are the Fool’ s stories and the stories I want to tell you.

About the Minor Arcana:

Like the deck itself, the Minor Arcana unfolds through narrative progression.

The Suit of Wands tells a tale of stars and fire, of a robot prince chasing his dream. The stars may be distant, even unreachable, but perhaps it’ s the act of burning oneself in pursuit of that elusive dream that defines the romance of Wands.

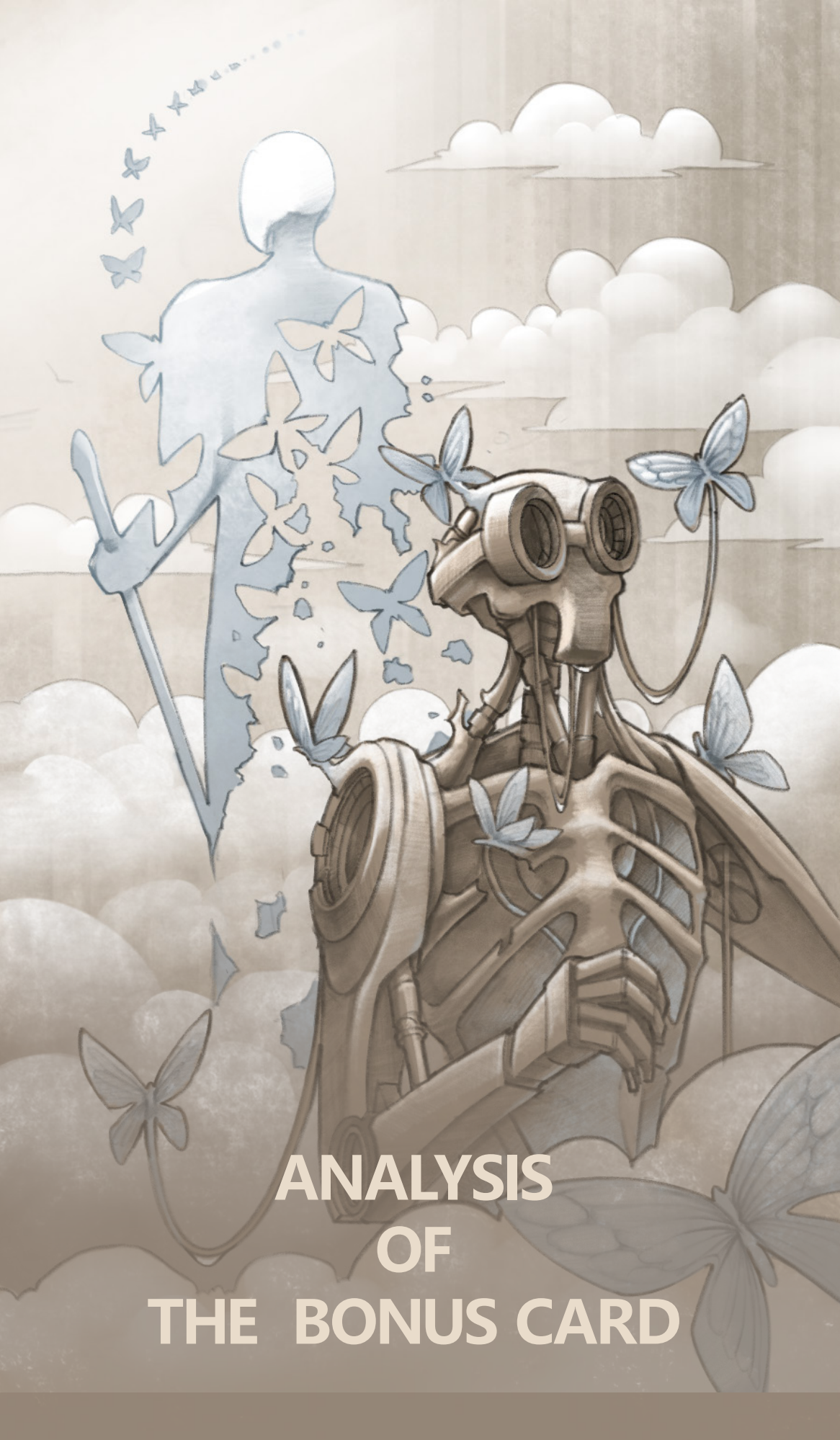
The Suit of Swords explores the bond between blade and will. I hope to portray someone who grows inward, someone who begins by being protected and eventually

gains the strength to protect others. Along the way, they find the truth of the blade. I wonder if you sense their transformation.

The Suit of Cups centers on friendship and connection. A sensitive swamp, traveling rain, and drifting clouds on the horizon – sometimes they meet, sometimes they remain apart. Perhaps one day, all waters will pour into the sea through the Cup, merging into one.

The Suit of Pentacles is about wealth and cooperation. Starlit flasks plant constellations, while visitors from beyond gather them. You may have noticed the flasks harvesting riches through collaboration, but did you catch the ancient tale of the pact made long ago between the bottles and the stars?

~Catalyst



ANALYSIS OF THE BONUS CARD



ITERATION

Interpretation:

A mechanical being has traversed countless cyclical journeys. Along this infinite path, it gradually awakens to the truth of life, discovering emotion, wisdom, and the spirit within. At last, it transcends its mechanical nature to become something more: a truly living soul.

Upright:

Inter-dimensional breakthrough; turning point or pivotal transformation; leap from accumulative to qualitative change; development that redefines the nature of events; new spiritual or intellectual height; radical redefinition of self

Reversed:

Missed opportunity for breakthrough; insufficiency preventing change; stagnation; regression; missed inflection point; standstill in understanding; halted growth in one’ s character development



7.THE CHARIOT

Interpretation:

The warrior stands firm atop the chariot, arms open wide to meet the rushing wind. With a single command, the two armored beasts unleash a low, thunderous roar and surge forward with powerful strides. The warrior's gaze is unwavering, fixed on the path ahead. Under his command, the mighty beasts move in perfect unison, charging across the wilderness and breaking through all obstacles in their way. They carry the weight of a kingdom’ s mission: to expand its borders and conquer the unknown. With every step, they leave deep impressions in the earth, forging boldly onward into uncharted lands.

Note:

Please refer to the original meaning of The Chariot while staying open to new reading approaches



9.THE HERMIT

Interpretation:

The summit is covered in snow; the biting wind has stilled. Silence blankets the world, broken only by the soft glow of an ancient starlit lantern before you. Its faint, warm light casts a golden halo amidst the vast expanse of white. You gently set down your well-worn hiking staff, your weary body sinking slowly to the ground. In this isolated realm of stillness, you gaze into the weathered lantern. As the snowflakes drift quietly around you, your thoughts begin to settle, falling into a long-lost, deeply familiar calm.

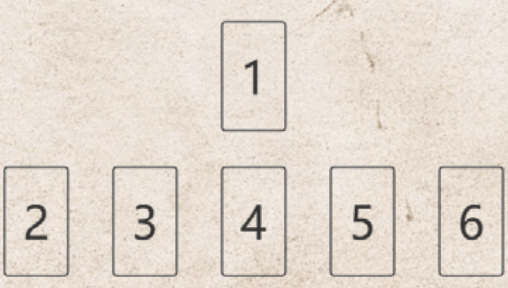
Note:

Please refer to the original meaning of The Chariot while staying open to new reading approaches



ANALYSIS OF THE ORIGINAL CONTENT

Original Tarot Spread: The Traveler's Path



The energy of this spread flows toward the right, mirroring a still unfolding journey. The five lower cards may follow a "2-2-1" or "2-1-2" formation – both arrangements are valid.

Card 1 represents the querent/traveler, revealing their most defining trait. Note: If the figure in the card is clearly facing left, the querent is asked to reflect on their past. Otherwise, it's time to plan ahead.

Card 2 represents the past or the querent's previous state.

Card 3 represents the experience gained from the past.

Card 4 represents the present. You may draw a clarifier if needed and interpret it in combination with Card 1 to form a more complete understand-

ing of the querent’ s current state.

Card 5, the most flexible position, represents the obstacle or blockage. It may be something one’ s facing now or a potential difficulty approaching from the future. The meaning of this card is yours to define, which is why it can appear in either the “2-2-1” or “2-1-2” layout.

Card 6 represents the gain/reward. It may be spiritual or material.

Font correspondence

A - 

B - 

C - 

D - 

E - 

F - 

G - 

H - 

I - 

J -

K - 

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M - 

N - 

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P - 

Q - 

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S - 

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W - 

X -

Y - 

Z - 

EPILOGUE

400 days of creation. 3 rounds of prototypes. 2 factory changes. 7 factory visits. Dozens of revisions, just for the card back... Through countless sleepless nights of "how to make it better," we can finally place Ethereal Poetry in your hands with confidence.

Our journey here has been filled with endless challenges, but thanks to the collective effort of so many, every obstacle was overcome.

Thanks to Catalyst, whose creativity, professionalism, and work ethics I deeply admire. Your brilliant strokes of pen, time and again, left me in awe. I'm grateful for the opportunity to shape this project with you.

To my old pal 黄猫儿, for venturing into a new field with me wholeheartedly, shouldering vital responsibilities in project planning and production, and offering strong execution and full support through every challenge.

To whitehill, for co-authoring the guidebook and offering wise insights from both the theoretical and practical aspects.

To 妙妙猫 , for offering crucial help and guidance with unwavering professionalism in our most difficult times.

To Vermilion Collection, our collaborators, and all the craftspeople who brought this project to life, for landing a big dream.

And my deepest thanks to you, dear fellow traveler. Your support, contribution, and willingness to share have made all this possible.

~ Sickle

"Sometimes I see myself as a storyteller. Thank you for listening." ~ Catalyst

"What a ride! My cat life is complete now!!!(just kidding)" ~ 黄猫儿

"Ethereal Poetry has come a long way. Thank you for your company. The journey continues. I wish you all the best." ~ whitehill

ETHEREAL POETRY